RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

22 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 5:51 AM, Thursday 22 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 111 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Halted** · 43 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,911 minutes at 6:00 AM; Dammam halted since 3:07 AM, 172 minutes, after one landing ended its 11:17 PM halt

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 14,911 minutes at 6:00 AM; NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight**.
- No Riyadh takeoffs or landings since the 3:00 AM edition; 111 Riyadh flights cancelled so far on Thursday (25%).
- Dammam airport halted since 3:07 AM, 172 minutes at 6:00 AM; its only movement since 3:00 AM was flynas XY895 landing from Cairo at 3:07 AM, which ended the 11:17 PM to 3:07 AM halt.
- GACA: the Wednesday evening attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport killed a resident and injured 8; no new attacks, interceptions or Civil Defense alerts found since 3:00 AM.
- Al Ekhbariya: Houthi escalation in Yemen's Marib threatens civilians (4:13 AM).

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14902 min).

111	0/0	2
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

HALTED

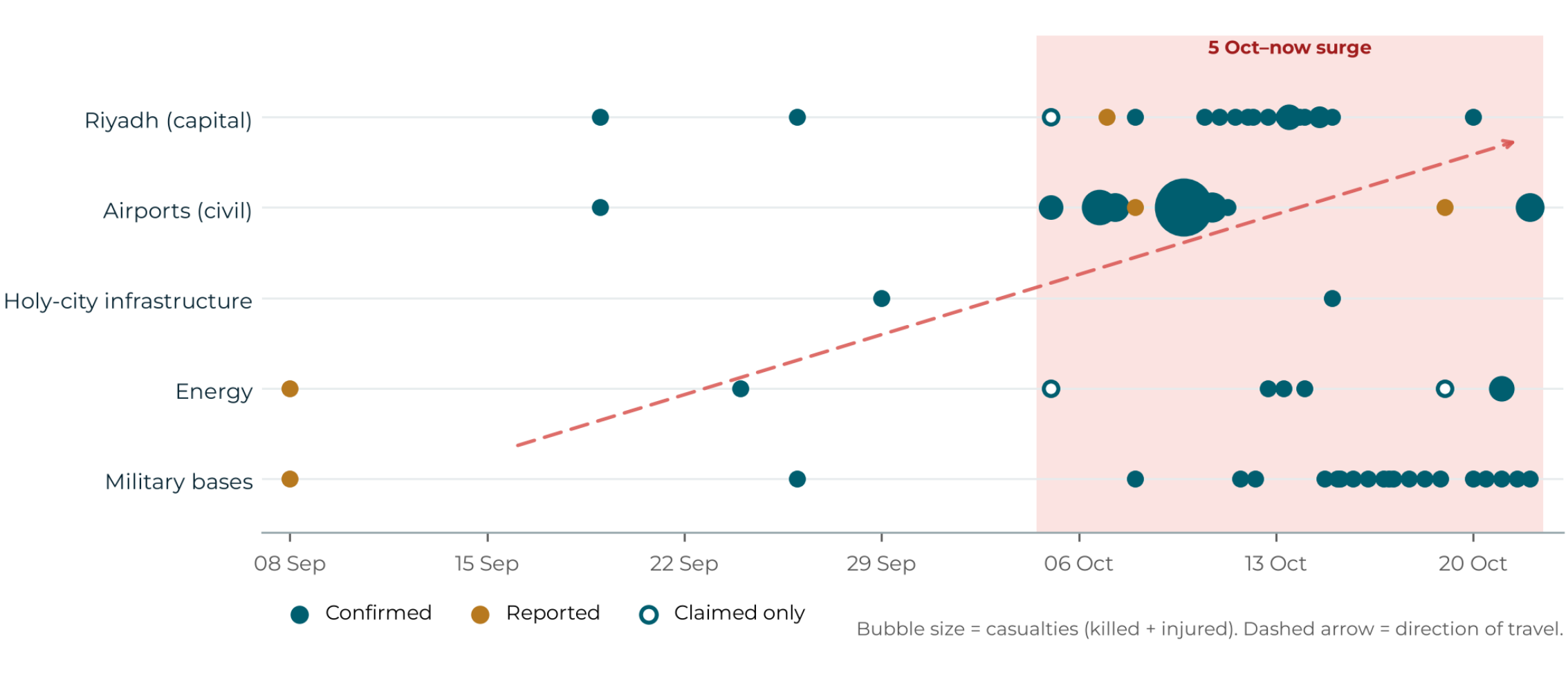
No takeoff or landing since 3:07 AM (164 min).

43	0/0	1
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- GACA: attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam on Wednesday evening killed 1 resident and injured 8 (statement 1:10 AM)
- Dammam halted since 11:17 PM (223 min at 3:00 AM); no movements since the 12:00 AM edition
- Coalition: 4 drones intercepted over the Eastern Region (1:04 AM)
- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (14,731 min at 3:00 AM); no movements since the 12:00 AM edition

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 22 OCT



Bubble size = casualties (killed + injured). Dashed arrow = direction of travel.

60 sourced events since 8 September (52 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region; targets and casualties not stated (22 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 3:00 AM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 3:00 AM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 1, interceptions 5.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Riyadh still halted; Dammam halted again after a single 3:07 AM landing; no new attacks since 3:00 AM

Checked at 5:55 AM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Houthi escalation in Marib threatens civilians and deepens fears of a wider humanitarian crisis**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **4:13 AM** · published 4:13 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:55 AM

Saudi state channel Al Ekhbariya reported that the Houthi escalation in Yemen's Marib is endangering civilians and raising fears that the humanitarian crisis will widen. No new attack on Saudi territory was reported.

CONFIRMED **Al Ekhbariya: Saudi-Russian dialogue session held in Moscow on bilateral ties**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **5:08 AM** · published 5:08 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic, translated); checked 5:55 AM

Moscow hosted a Saudi-Russian dialogue session to discuss developing bilateral relations and closer alignment amid international changes, Al Ekhbariya reported.

CONFIRMED DMM **GACA: attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam kills a resident and injures 8; material damage being assessed**

GACA (@ksagaca) / SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **1:10 AM** · GACA statement published 1:10 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic), English 1:30 AM, SPA English 1:54 AM; checked 2:55 AM; AP also reported the death (updated 2:23 AM AST); checked 5:55 AM

The General Authority of Civil Aviation said an attack targeted King Fahd International Airport in Dammam on Wednesday evening, killing one resident and injuring eight, who were taken to hospital with injuries ranging from minor to severe. GACA said the attack caused material damage that is being assessed and that updates will follow. It did not give the exact time of the attack, the weapon used or any change to airport operations.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: four drones intercepted and destroyed over the Eastern Region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA · **1:04 AM** · published 1:04 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (Arabic; SPA English 1:14 AM); checked 2:55 AM

The coalition spokesman said four drones were intercepted and destroyed in the Eastern Region. Targets, debris and casualties were not stated.

CONFIRMED **Egypt's President Sisi: the military effort defends the Kingdom and includes no offensive in Yemen**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:38 AM** · published 1:38 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 2:55 AM

Al Ekhbariya quoted Egyptian President Abdel Fattah el-Sisi as saying the military effort is to defend Saudi Arabia and does not include an attack on Yemen, and that standing with Gulf states is an extension of Arab national security.

CONFIRMED **Yemen's Defense Ministry: Houthi tribal rallies and mobilisation gatherings will be legitimate military targets**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv) · **1:59 AM** · published 1:59 AM AST Thu 22 Oct (translated from Arabic); checked 2:55 AM; Al Ekhbariya repeated it at 3:16 AM

Al Ekhbariya reported that Yemen's (internationally recognised government's) Defense Ministry said gatherings organised by the Houthis under the names of tribal mobilisation, mass rallies and cultural courses will be legitimate military targets.

CONFIRMED **Ministry of Energy: drone aimed at a Shaybah field facility intercepted; falling debris killed 2 residents and injured 2**

SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **10:08 PM** · published 10:08 PM AST Wed 21 Oct (official account; Arabic SPA 9:57 PM); checked 11:55 PM

The Ministry of Energy said air defences intercepted a drone on Wednesday morning that tried to target a facility at Aramco's Shaybah field in the Eastern Province. Falling debris killed two residents (a Filipino and a Nepali) and injured two (a Pakistani and an Indian), and a contractor's vehicle caught fire outside the facility.

UNVERIFIED **Reuters, relayed on X: US preparing ordered departure of non-emergency staff and families from Gulf embassies**

Reuters via @osinthexagone · **10:01 PM** · posted 10:01 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; Reuters article not checked directly; checked 11:55 PM

Accounts on X citing Reuters say the State Department is preparing an ordered departure of non-emergency personnel and family members from Gulf posts, citing possible renewed Houthi attacks. No State Department announcement yet.

CONFIRMED **US State Department travel advisory: Houthi attacks on Saudi civilian airports and infrastructure could escalate**

US State Dept (@TravelGov) · **9:31 PM** · published 9:31 PM AST Wed 21 Oct; checked 11:55 PM

The US State Department said Iranian-supported Houthis have attacked civilian airports and other critical infrastructure in Saudi Arabia, causing civilian casualties and severe travel disruption, and warned the hostilities could escalate. A US Mission update relayed on X says Riyadh airport operations remain suspended while Jeddah and Dammam operate with some delays and cancellations.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (14902 min).

111
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
50 departures + 61 arrivals, 25% of 440 scheduled.

4:33 AM
LAST TAKEOFF
HZA8 to Heraklion (non-airline flight), 1518 min before 5:51 AM. Last airline: SV982, 3:02 AM.

10:49 PM
LAST LANDING
SV993 from Shenzhen, 422 min before 5:51 AM.

0
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

2
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
Mostly to Jeddah, Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 110 at 5:52 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**50**	**61**	**111**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**50 (23%)**	**60 (27%)**	**110**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**0 (0%)**	**1 (0%)**	**1**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**1 (100%)**	**1 (50%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 29**	**0 of 43**	**0 of 72**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**2**	**2**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**26**	**28**	**54**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**181**	**195**	**376**	FR24 stats panel

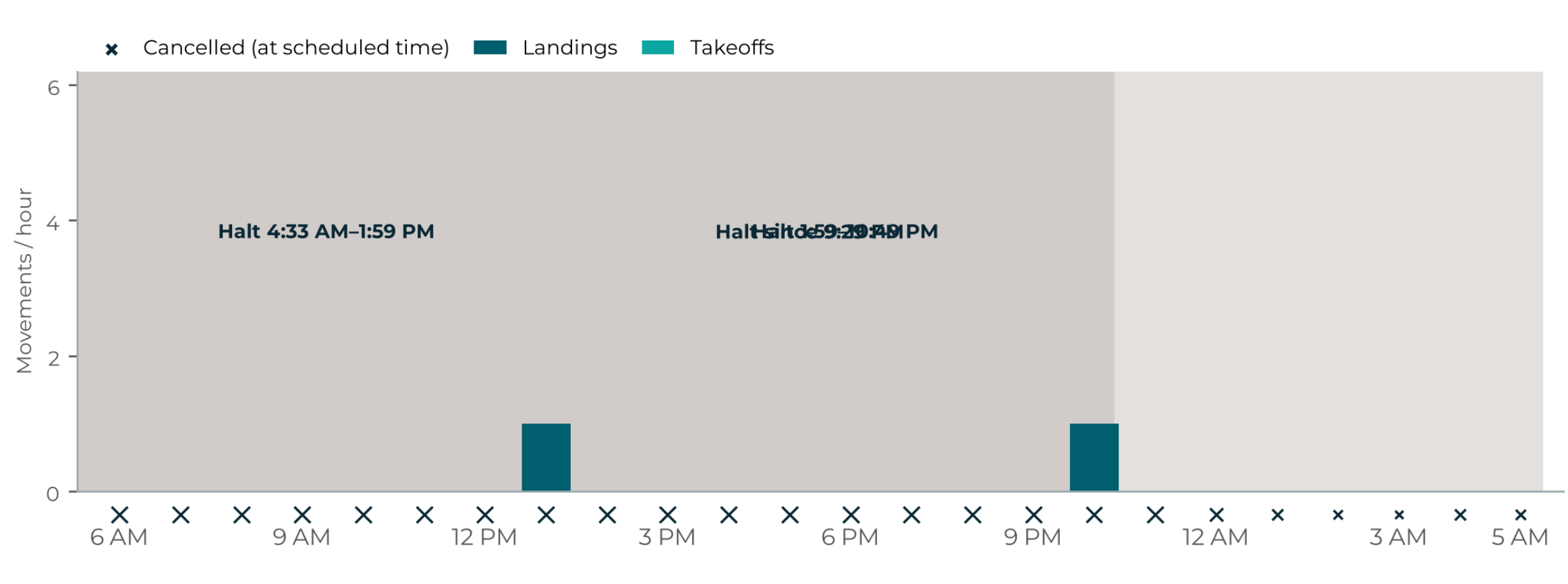
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	**54**
flynas	**12**
Gulf Air	**10**
Royal Jordanian	**8**
Emirates	**6**

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	**44**
Madinah	**15**
Bahrain	**12**
Dubai	**11**
Amman	**7**

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



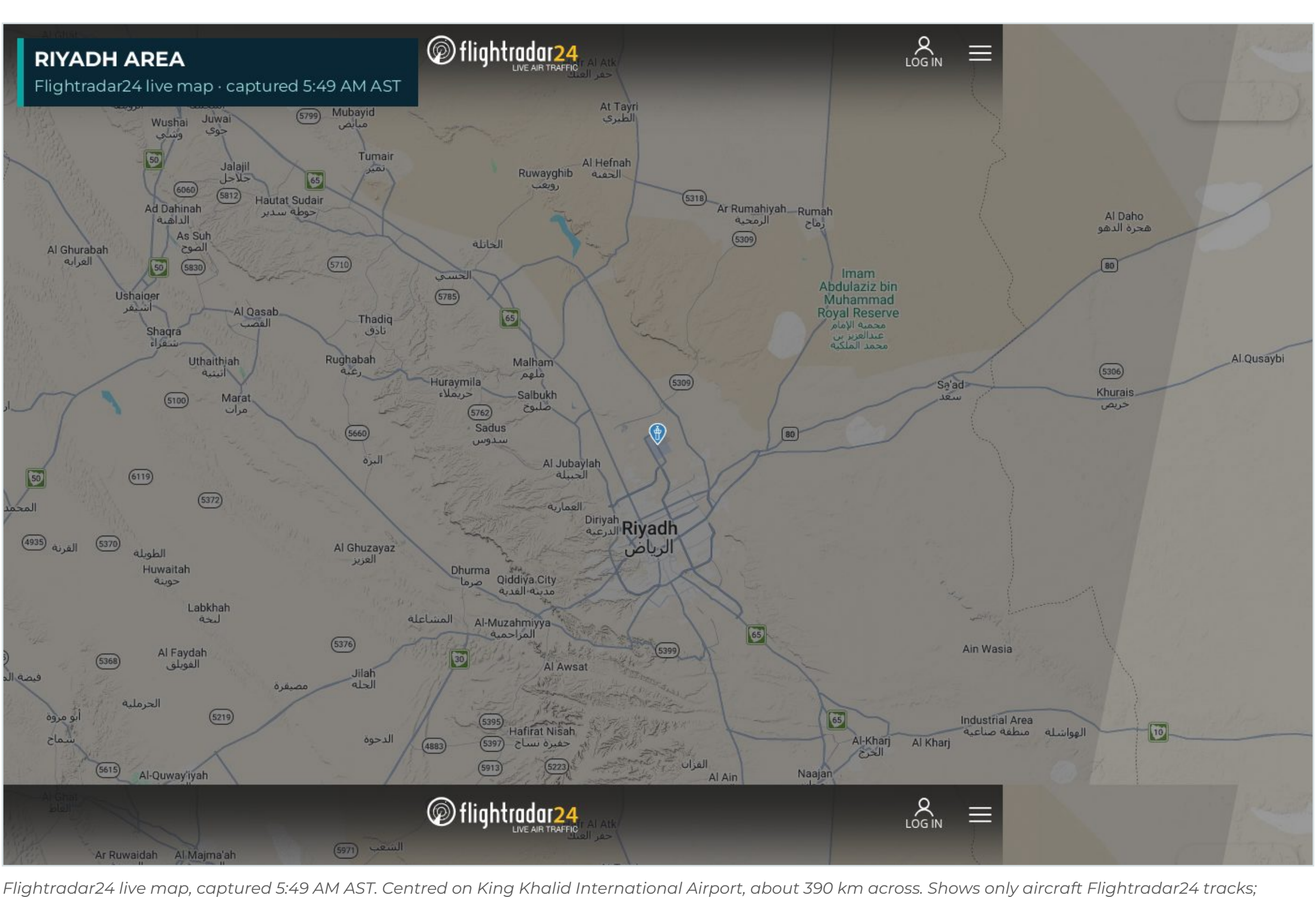
Recorded takeoffs (0) and landings (2) at RUH per hour from 6:00 AM Wednesday to 5:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are the HZA8 landing at 1:59 PM and the delayed Saudia SV993 landing at 10:49 PM Wednesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 8:54–9:48 PM, 9:56–10:55 PM and 11:17 PM–3:07 AM, and one has been open since 3:07 AM.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 1:59–10:49 PM	530 min
Halt 4:33 AM–1:59 PM	566 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	14902 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:49 AM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 3:07 AM (164 min).

43
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY
22 departures + 21 arrivals, 17% of 253 scheduled.

11:02 PM
LAST TAKEOFF
F3318 to Jeddah, 409 min before 5:51 AM.

3:07 AM
LAST LANDING
XY895 from Cairo, 164 min before 5:51 AM.

0
TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR
0 landings in the last hour.

1
ARRIVALS DIVERTED
Mostly to Madinah.

***Cancellation basis:** Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 5:51 AM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 43 at 5:52 AM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	**22**	**21**	**43**	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	**22 (18%)**	**21 (16%)**	**43**	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	**2 (2%)**	**6 (5%)**	**8**	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	**0 (0%)**	**2 (25%)**	**2**	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	**0 min**	**0 min**	**—**	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	**0 of 18**	**1 of 24**	**1 of 42**	FR24 boards
Diverted today	**—**	**1**	**1**	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	**1**	**3**	**4**	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	**35**	**39**	**74**	FR24 stats panel

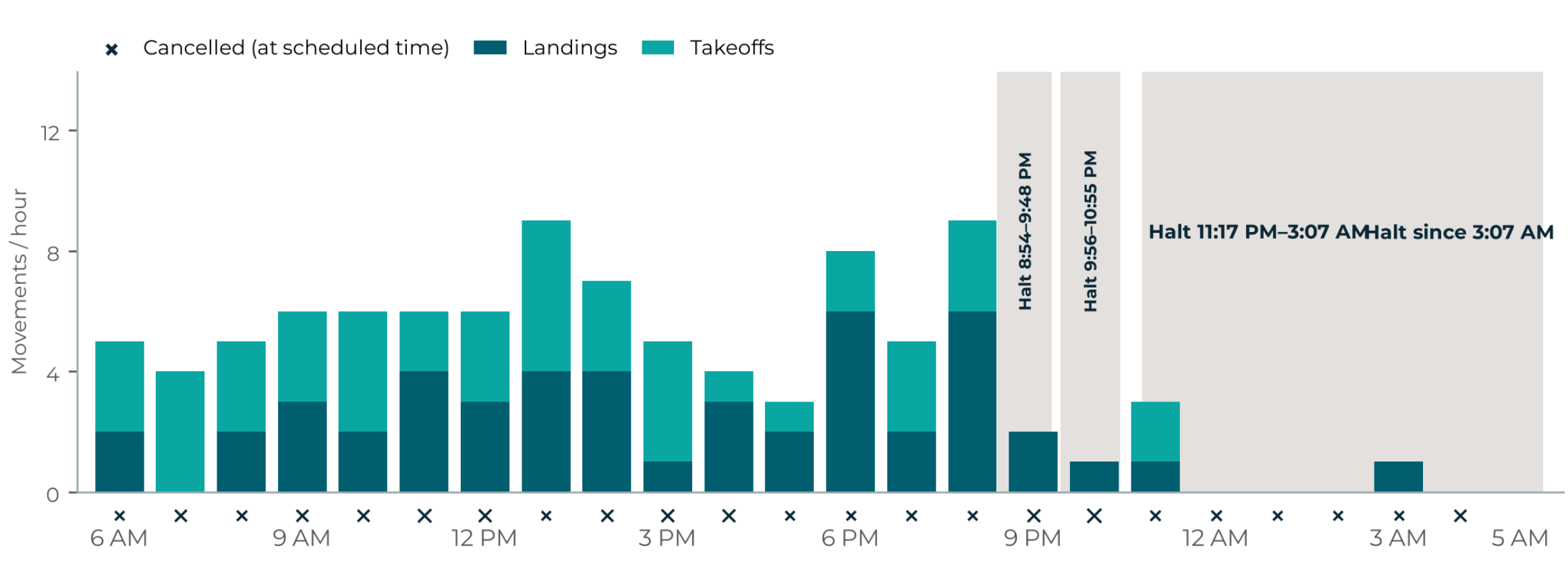
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Emirates	**8**
Etihad Airways	**8**
flydubai	**8**
Egyptair	**6**
Saudia	**5**

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Dubai	**16**
Abu Dhabi	**8**
Jeddah	**7**
Cairo	**6**
Madinah	**3**

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (46) and landings (49) at DMM per hour from 6:00 AM Wednesday to 5:51 AM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Halted since 3:07 AM (172 min at 6:00 AM); only movement since 3:00 AM was flynas XY895 landing from Cairo at 3:07 AM.

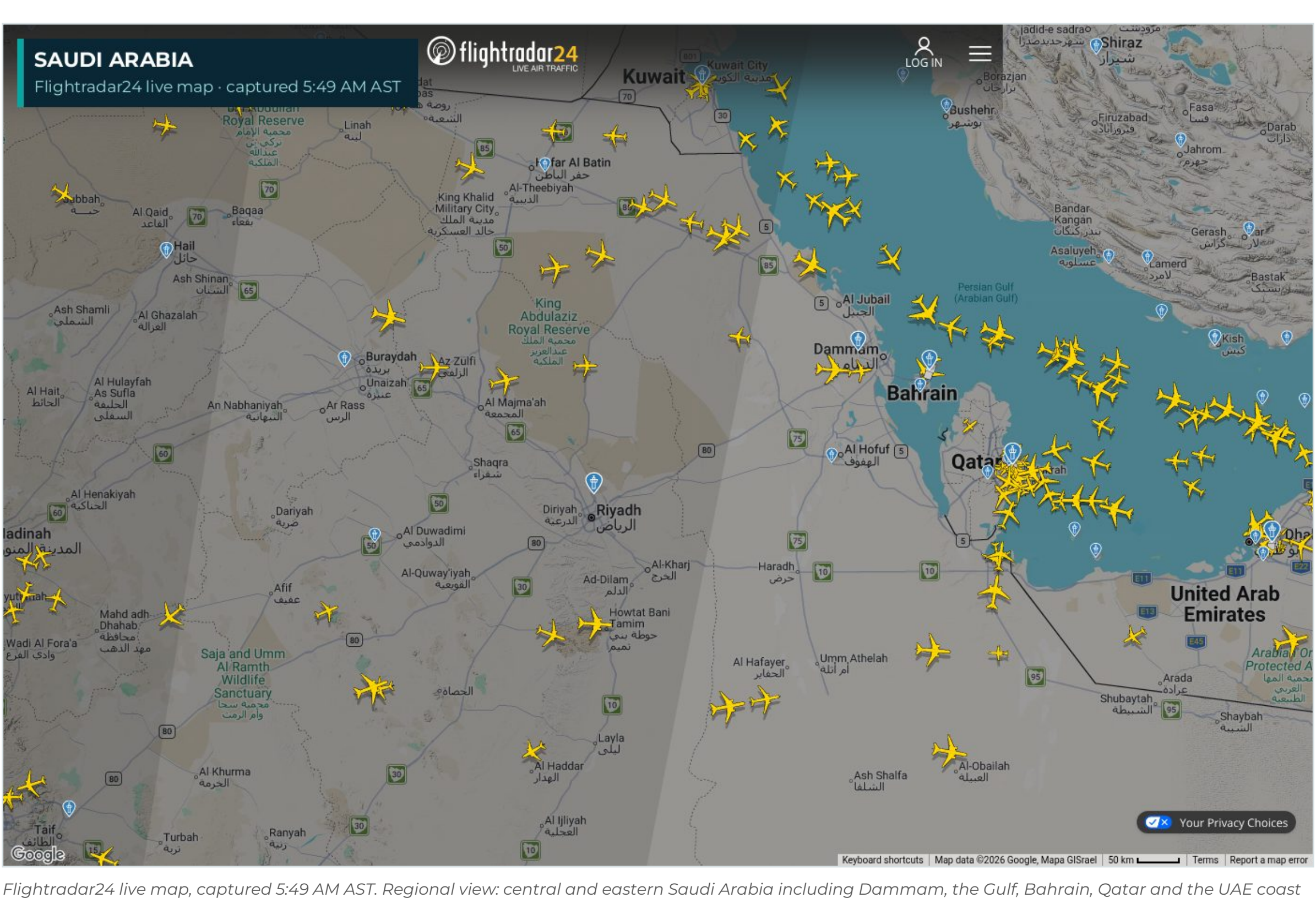
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

OPEN Halt since 3:07 AM	164 min and counting
Halt 11:17 PM–3:07 AM	230 min
Halt 9:56–10:55 PM	58 min
Halt 8:54–9:48 PM	54 min
Halt 3:58–5:59 AM	120 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

CONFIRMED **GACA: attack on King Fahd International Airport in Dammam kills a resident and injures 8; material damage being assessed** (GACA (@ksagaca) / SPA (@Spa_Eng) · 1:10 AM)

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



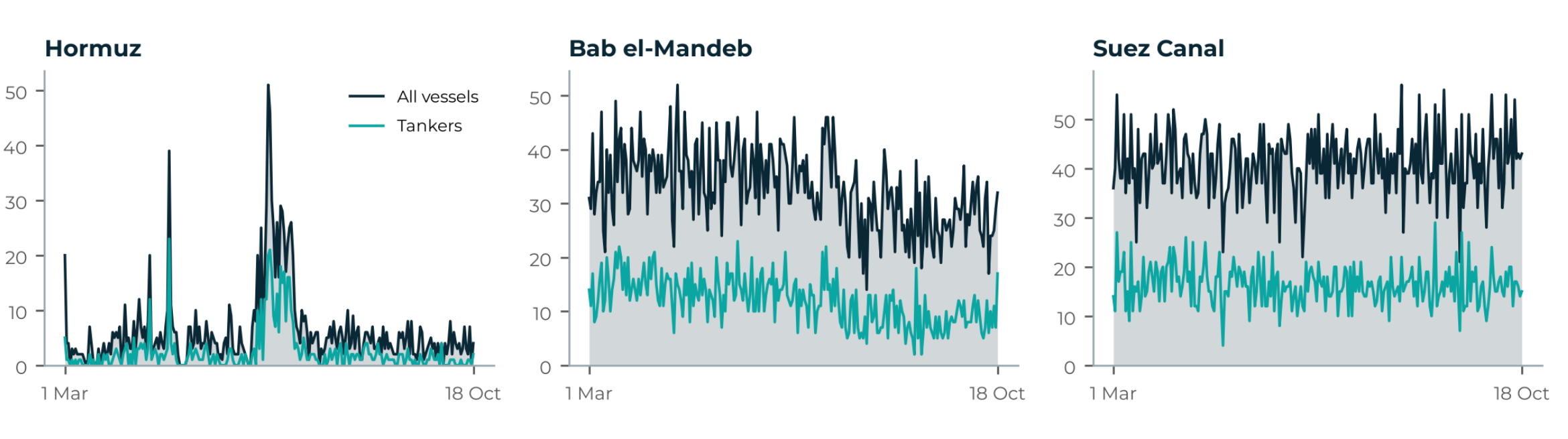
Flightradar24 live map, captured 5:49 AM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

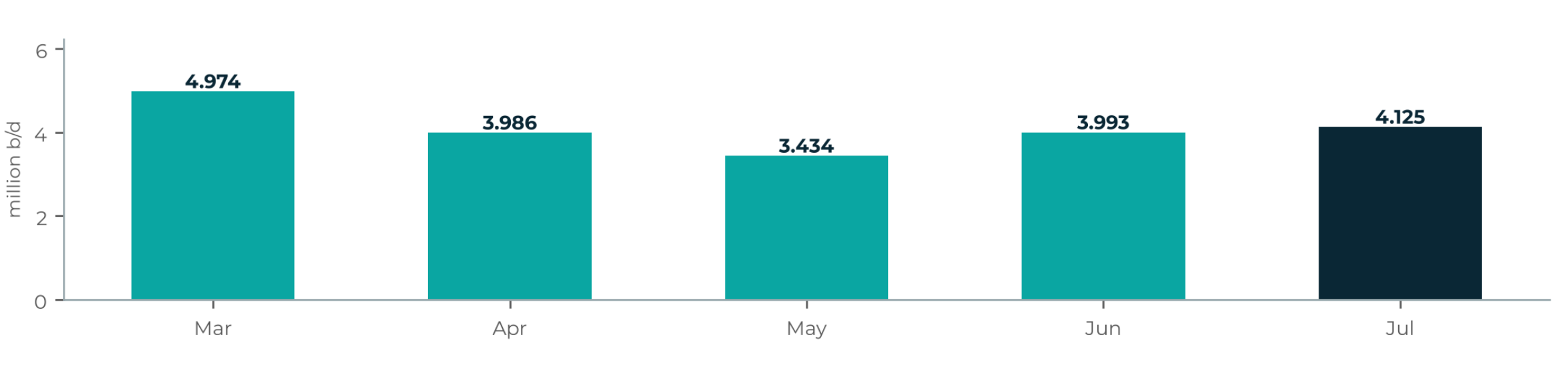
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



*Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. **Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.** Fetched 5:52 AM, Thu 22 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)



Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

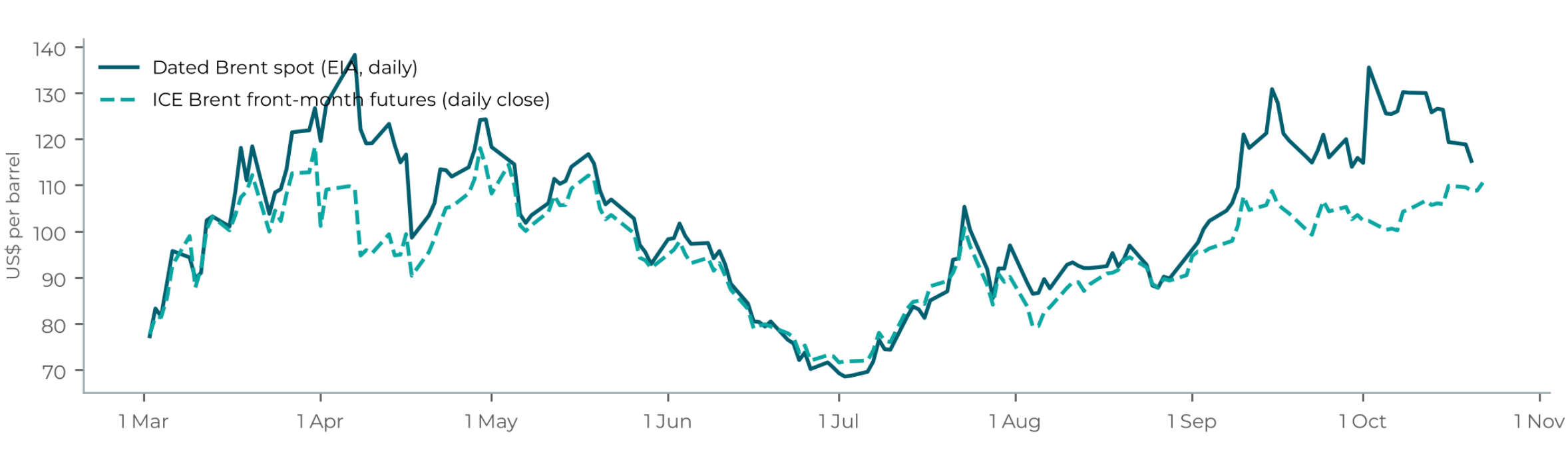
BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$110.55
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST
ICE front-month, 5:41 AM, Thu 22 Oct AST (+1.6% on day). Near real time.

$115.22
DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)
Tue 20 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.

-4%
SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE
From $119.66 on Fri 18 Sep.

+49%
SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 5:51 AM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
5:51 AM, Thu 22 Oct	5:51 AM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Halted**	Open sources · not official	9:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 9:00 AM